

Marta Massaia

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<https://martamassaia.github.io/>

Employment

- Sep 2025 – Feb 2026 **Lecturer**, 0,8 FTE
Utrecht University, The Netherlands.
- B.A. *Duitse taal en cultuur* [German language and culture]
 - M.A. *Meertaligheid en taalverwerving - Track Duits* [Multilingualism and language acquisition, German track]

Education

- Oct 2021 – *present* **Ph.D. Linguistics**
Utrecht University, The Netherlands
- THESIS TITLE: The Syntax of Similarity Constructions: Similitative and Simulative Clauses from a Cross-Germanic Perspective
 - PROMOTOR: Norbert Corver
 - CO-PROMOTORS: Denis Delfitto, Marijana Marelj
- Nov 2019 – Jul 2021 **M.A. Scienze del Linguaggio [Language Sciences]**, *cum laude*
Ca' Foscari University, Italy
- MAJORS: German, Swedish
 - THESIS TITLE: *Zwischen Form und Skopus: Eine syntaktische Analyse des italienischen allora* [Between form and scope: A syntactic analysis of Italian allora]
 - SUPERVISORS: Roland Hinterhölzl, Alessandra Giorgi
- Sep 2016 – Oct 2019 **B.A. Lingue, Civiltà e Scienze del Linguaggio [Language, Civilisation and the Science of Language]**, *cum laude*
Ca' Foscari University, Italy
- MAJORS: German, Swedish
 - THESIS TITLE: *Unpersönliche Passivierung im Deutschen: Effekte der Telizität und der Agentivität auf die Passivfähigkeit intransitiver Verben* [Impersonal passivization in German: Telicity and agentivity effects on the ability to passivize intransitive verbs]
 - SUPERVISOR: Peter Martin Paschke

Non-degree Studies

- 25 Feb 2025 **Workshop Preparing for the job market: Exploring your skillset**
Graduate School of Humanities, Utrecht University, The Netherlands
- 17-21 Jun 2024 **LOT Summer School**
Leiden University, The Netherlands
- *The Syntax of Questions* (Michelle Sheehan)
 - *The Semantics of (In)Definite DPs, with Special Focus on West African* (Malte Zimmerman)
- 26 Mar 2024 **Workshop Integrity in the Workplace**
Graduate School of Humanities, Utrecht University, The Netherlands
- 28 Feb 2024 **Workshop Introduction to LaTeX**
Centre for Digital Humanities, Utrecht University, The Netherlands

Non-degree Studies (continued)

Dec 2023 – Feb 2024	Basiskwalificatie Onderwijs (BKO-)deeltraject [University Teaching Qualification (UTQ) modular certificate track] Graduate School of Humanities, Utrecht University, The Netherlands
15-28 Jul 2023	5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics University of Crete, Greece • <i>Agreement Systems</i> (Elena Anagnostopoulou and Ümit Atlamaz) • <i>Introduction to Semantics</i> (Cleo Condoravdi) • <i>Intermediate Syntax</i> (Caroline Heycock)
10-14 Jul 2023	LOT Summer School Utrecht University, The Netherlands • <i>The Syntax of Talking Heads</i> (Martina Wiltschko) • <i>Advanced Introduction to Morphology</i> (Alec Marantz)
16-20 Jan 2023	LOT Winter School University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands • <i>Dissimilation and Clause Size</i> (David Pesetsky)
20-24 Jun 2022	LOT Summer School University of Groningen, The Netherlands • <i>Quantificational Variability – Internal Built and External Syntax of Negative Polarity Items and WH</i> (Gertjan Postma)
10-14 Jan 2022	LOT Winter School Vrije Universiteit (VU) Amsterdam, The Netherlands • <i>Adventures in Phrase Structure Theory</i> (Ad Neeleman) • <i>Modality and Polarity-Sensitivity</i> (Hedde Zeijlstra)
24 Dec 2019	Online training course <i>Linguaggio, Identità di Genere e Lingua Italiana</i> [Language, gender identity and the Italian language] Ca' Foscari University, Italy
24 Jul – 11 Aug 2018	Summer school <i>Läsa och Skriva i Dalarna: Ett Kreativt Möte med Språk, Kultur och Litteratur</i> [Studying and writing in Dalarna: a creative meeting with language, culture and literature] Malungs Fölkhögskola, Sweden

Publications

In press	Massaia, Marta. The syntax of simulation in Scandinavian and beyond. In Lukasz Jedrzejowski & Ásgrímur Angantýsson (eds.), <i>On the Syntax of Adverbial Clauses in Scandinavian: A Comparative Perspective</i> . Berlin/New York: Language Science Press.
2026	Massaia, Marta. Allora as an Italian discourse particle. <i>Linguistik Online</i> 146(5): 215-238. pdf ↗
2025	Massaia, Marta. The syntax of similitive clauses: Insights from Germanic. <i>Linguisticae Investigationes</i> 48(2): 189-220. pdf ↗ Massaia, Marta. Mapping the left periphery of similitive constructions: Dutch dialects as a case study. <i>Languages</i> 10(3): 47. pdf ↗

Edited volumes/special issues

2025	Corver, Norbert, Cloin-Tavenier, Lex & Massaia, Marta (eds.). Special Issue <i>Mind your Manner Adverbials!</i> <i>Languages</i> 10. pdf ↗
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Databases

2025	Corver, Norbert, Cloin-Tavenier, Lex, Massaia, Marta , Krips, Iris, Wensink, Tess, Spoel, Sheean, & van Stiphout, Mees. MiMA-database. ↗
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Presentations

Peer-reviewed

- 2026 **Massaia, Marta.** Fronting similar manners in different ways: Accounting for a topicalization asymmetry in similative and simulative clauses. *Adverbial Clauses: New Horizons*, FU Berlin.
- 2025 **Massaia, Marta.** Adverbial clauses as relative clauses? The view from similarity constructions. *Adverbial Clauses as Relative Clauses: Old Questions, New Answers*, University of Hamburg.
- 2024 **Massaia, Marta.** Similative clauses as relative clauses: Evidence from West-Germanic. *Germanic Sandwich 9*, Lancaster University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Mood alternations in simulative clauses: The (minor) role of subjunctive in the expression of irrealis. Workshop *Mood Alternation in Adverbial Clauses*, FU Berlin.
- 2023 **Massaia, Marta.** The Syntax of simulative clauses: as-clause+if-clause, as if-clause, or as+if-clause? *ÖLT 2023 Current Issues in Syntax, Semantics, and Pragmatics*, University of Graz.
- Massaia, Marta.** A cross-Germanic perspective on simulative clauses. *International Conference on the Variation of Adverbial Clauses*, University of Göttingen.
- Massaia, Marta.** Similative clauses as relative clauses: Evidence from Germanic. *TABU Dag 2023*, University of Groningen.
- Massaia, Marta.** On similative clauses in Germanic. *On the Diachrony of Adverbial Clauses*, University of Tübingen.

Internal/invited

- 2026 **Massaia, Marta.** Topicalizing manners. *Grote Taal dag*, Utrecht University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Topicalizing manners. *Syntax Circle*, Leiden University.
- 2025 **Massaia, Marta.** How similar are similatives and simulative clauses? *RUG Syntax Seminar*, University of Groningen.
- Massaia, Marta.** How similar are similatives and simulative clauses? *MiMA-workshop on The Grammar of Manner Adverbials*, Utrecht University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Mapping the left periphery of Germanic similative clauses: Dutch dialects as a case study. *Grote Taal dag*, Utrecht University.
- 2024 **Massaia, Marta.** Germanic simulative clauses: as-clause + if-clause, as if + clause, or as + if-clause? *Research Seminar in Linguistics*, Ulster University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Mapping the left periphery of similarity constructions in Germanic. *SyntaxLab*, University of Cambridge.
- Massaia, Marta.** The syntax of simulation: A new perspective from Germanic. *LOT Summer School*, Leiden University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Mapping the left periphery of similarity constructions in Germanic: Dutch dialects as case study. *Syntax Square*, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT).
- 2023 **Massaia, Marta.** The Syntax of simulation in Germanic. *MiMA-project midway workshop*, Utrecht University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Similative clauses as relative clauses: Evidence from Germanic. *The 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics*, University of Crete.
- Massaia, Marta.** A cross-Germanic perspective on simulative clauses: Some thoughts and questions. *LOT Summer School*, Utrecht University.
- Massaia, Marta.** Decomposing clausal manner adverbials. *Syntax Seminar Talks*, University of Verona.
- 2021 **Massaia, Marta.** "Allora" als Diskurspartikel des Italienischen. *Ways of Expressing Modality. German Modal Particles from a Comparative Perspective*, Ca' Foscari University.

Teaching

Main instructor

UTRECHT UNIVERSITY

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Forschen und Schreiben [Research and Writing in German] – B.A. 3 / DU3V18001 [↗](#)
Kultur und Kommunikation im deutschen Kontext [Culture and Communication in the German Context] – M.A. / TLMV16304 [↗](#)

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

Sprachliche Strukturen im Diskurs [Linguistic Structures in Discourse] – B.A. 3 / DU3V15102 [↗](#)
Sprache und Kommunikation erforschen [Language and Communication Research] – B.A. 3 / DU3V19001 [↗](#)

12-16 Aug 2024

Introduction to Generative Syntax, Utrecht Summer School.

14-18 Aug 2023

Introduction to Generative Syntax, Utrecht Summer School.

15-19 Aug 2022

Introduction to Generative Syntax, Utrecht Summer School.

Teaching Assistant

UTRECHT UNIVERSITY

Sep 2023 – Nov 2023

TA for *From Language to Linguistics* – B.A. 1 / TW1V13001 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Marijana Marelj

Sep 2022 – Nov 2022

TA for *From Language to Linguistics* – B.A. 1 / TW1V13001 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Marijana Marelj

CA' FOSCARI UNIVERSITY

Apr 2021 – Jun 2021

TA for *Lingua Tedesca 3* [German language 3] – B.A. 3 / LT0072 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Roland Hinterhölzl

Oct 2020 – Dec 2020

TA for *Linguistica Generale 1* [General linguistics 1] – B.A. 1 / LT0240 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Nicola Munaro

Jun 2020 – Dec 2020

TA for *Lingua Tedesca 2* [German language 2] – B.A. 2 / LT0062 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Federica Cognola

Dec 2019 – Jan 2020

TA for *Lingua Tedesca 1* [German language 1] – B.A. 1 / LT0052 [↗](#)
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Peter Martin Paschke

Guest lecturer

UTRECHT UNIVERSITY

17 Feb 2026

Guest lecture for *Topics in Morpho-Syntax* – R.M.A. / TLRMV24102 [↗](#)
TITLE: The syntax of similative clauses
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Norbert Corver

30 Mar 2022

Guest lecture for *Deutsch im Sprachvergleich* [Comparative Germanic linguistics] – B.A. 3 / DU3V17006 [↗](#)
TITLE: Ma allora.. ist allora eine Modalpartikel des Italienischen denn?
MAIN INSTRUCTOR: Stefan Sudhoff

Research visits

24-30 Jun 2024

Short research visit at the University of Cambridge, UK
CONTACT PERSON: Theresa Biberauer

10-25 May 2024

Research visit at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA
CONTACT PERSON: David Pesetsky

1-5 May 2023

Short research visit at the University of Verona, Italy
CONTACT PERSON: Denis Delfitto

Research visits (continued)

Feb – Jun 2021	(Online) internship at the University of Göttingen, Germany CONTACT PERSON: Marco Coniglio
Oct 2018 – Mar 2019	International Mobility Programme (Erasmus+) at the University of Cologne, Germany · <i>Deutschsprachige Literatur der Moderne</i> [Modern German literature] (Ingo Breuer) · <i>Einführung in die Pragmatik</i> [Introduction to pragmatics] (Claudia Wegener) · <i>Syntax</i> (Sophie Repp)

Data collection

Jun 2023	Frisian; questionnaire distributed in collaboration with the Fryske Akademy Various Dutch dialects; questionnaire distributed in collaboration with the Meertens Institute.
Jan – Feb 2023	Various Dutch dialects; questionnaire distributed in collaboration with the Meertens Institute.

Academic service

Organization

2021 – present	Co-organizer of the <i>Syntax Interface Lectures</i> (SIL ↗), Utrecht University.
2025	Co-organizer of the <i>Uiltjesdagen</i> , 2-3 Apr 2025, Utrecht University. Co-organizer of the <i>MiMA-Workshop on the Grammar of Manner Adverbials</i> , 6-7 Mar 2025, Utrecht University.
2023	Co-organizer of the <i>MiMA-project midway workshop</i> , 10 Nov 2023, Utrecht University. Co-organizer of the LOT Summer School, 3-14 Jul 2023, Utrecht University

Reviewing

Journals	<i>Ad hoc</i> reviewer for: <i>Isogloss</i> (1x, 2026; 1x, 2024)
Conferences	<i>Going Romance</i> 40 (2026); <i>MiMA-Workshop on The Grammar of Manner Adverbials</i> (2025)

Other

29 Nov 2024	Member of the LOT PhD candidates panel during the LOT research evaluation.
11-13 Nov 2024	Member of the PhD-panel during the <i>facultaire onderzoeksvisitatie</i> [faculty research visitation/evaluation] at Utrecht University.

Academic memberships

2025 – present	Member of the Dutch <i>Syntax Circle</i> ↗ Member of the <i>Associazione Italiana di Studi Strindbergiani</i> (ASTRI) [Italian association of Strindbergian studies]
2022 – present	Member of the <i>Algemene Vereniging voor Taalwetenschap</i> (AVT) [General association for linguistics] ↗
2021 – present	Member of the International Scientific Network <i>Adverbial Clauses and Subordinate Dependency Relationships</i> ↗

Languages

Italian	native
English	near native
German	advanced
Dutch	lower intermediate
French	lower intermediate
Swedish	basic
Spanish	basic

Other skills

Operating systems	Microsoft Windows
Typesetting	$\text{\LaTeX}$
Text processing	Microsoft Word
Reference management	Bib $\text{\TeX}$
Data analysis	Microsoft Excel
Web development	Javascript, HTML, CSS, WordPress